COMPOSER · RESEARCHER

Francesco Vitucci

Composer, electroacoustic performer and researcher based in Bari, Italy.



Francesco Vitucci is an Italian composer and researcher based in Bari. His practice spans instrumental and electronic music, notation, and computational approaches to composition.

Education

In 2016 he obtained the First Level Academic Diploma in "Composition" with full marks and honours, under the guidance of Biagio Putignano, at the "Niccolò Piccinni" Conservatory in Bari. With the same teacher and at the same institution, he attended the experimental Second Level two-year programme in "Musical disciplines with a technological focus - Composition", obtaining the diploma in 2018 with full marks and a special mention from the committee.

In May 2020 he obtained the Master of Advanced Studies in "Music Composition" with full marks and honours at the Conservatory of Italian Switzerland in Lugano, under the guidance of Nadir Vassena.

In June 2022, under the guidance of Ivan Fedele, he obtained the Advanced Specialization Diploma in "Composition" at the Accademia Nazionale di Santa Cecilia in Rome, with full marks and honours. At the same institution, he attended the "Electronic Music" course taught by Michelangelo Lupone.

In July 2024, under the guidance of Francesco Scagliola, he obtained the Second Level Academic Diploma in Electronic Music with full marks, honours and academic mention at the "Niccolò Piccinni" Conservatory in Bari. He is currently a PhD candidate at the same institution in "Computational electroacoustic music composition, generative algorithmic models and computational complexity".

Among the artists with whom he has furthered his studies in courses and masterclasses, in Italy and abroad, are Reinhard Febel, Julian Anderson, Luigi Ceccarelli, Carlo Infante, Elio Martusciello, Riccardo Santoboni, Daniela Terranova, Maurizio Azzan, Zeno Baldi, Giulia Lorusso, Anssi Karttunen, Steven Dann and Lisa Fornhammar.

Awards and Distinctions

His works have been positively evaluated in several national and international composition competitions.

In November 2015 he took part in the First International Composition Competition "Music and Poetry between Italy and Japan", organized by the Italian Cultural Institute in Osaka, winning publication of the piece "Respiri erosi" for soprano, flute and guitar.

In 2017 his composition "Triptych of Human Sound", for violin, cello and piano, received an extraordinary mention from the jury of the third edition of the "Vittorio Fellegara" International Composition Competition. His "5 haiku" for voice and cello were among the finalists of the International Call for Scores - Musica Prospettiva 2019-20.

In March 2021, "Triptych", for flute, clarinet, violin, cello and piano, won the "Coloana infinitului" International Composition Competition in Romania. In the same year he won First Prize in the "2 Agosto" International Composition Competition with "Nelle pieghe" for orchestra, while "Stella" for soprano and piano, on a text by Alfredo Panzini, received both the "Best piece of the trilogy" award and the "Best piece among the youngest composers" award at the 1st International Composition Competition "Chamber songs on texts by poets and writers of the Romagna House Museums", organized by N.O.T.A. Music.

In May 2022, "Neve / Schnee", for soprano and piano on a text by Tilo Krause, won both the Jurypreis and the Publikumpreis at the "Junges Lied-Wettbewerb" competition in Zurich. In October 2022 he received the Grand Prix at the 4th International Composer Competition "New Music Generation 2022", organized by the Kazakh National University of Arts.

In January 2023 he was a finalist in the "Luciano Berio" International Composition Competition. His piece "A deep breath", for quadraphonic digital fixed media and live electronics on S.T.ON3L, was selected for the International Computer Music Conference 2024, held at Hanyang University in Seoul, where it was presented in its world premiere.

In October 2024 he received the Goffredo Petrassi Award from the President of the Italian Republic Sergio Mattarella as the best student of the Composition Course at the Accademia Nazionale di Santa Cecilia for the year 2022.

Artistic and Concert Activity

An ordinary member of S.I.M.C. (Italian Society of Contemporary Music), his works are performed in concerts and contemporary music festivals in Italy and abroad. Among the most significant occasions are the staging of the ballet "La Tempesta", the result of a collaboration with the University of California Irvine, and several performances in the United States and Croatia.

As a member of the EGCAM group for applied music, in 2015 he created a sonorization for the Contemporary Sacred Art festival "Pro Arte Pro Deo" in Monteroni di Lecce, presenting the works "Di luce e attimi lontani" and "Istanti d'ombra". He also took part in the multimedia project "Comporre insieme", promoted by S.I.M.C. and L'Artificio, presenting "Imprinting" in Reggio Emilia in December 2018.

He has collaborated several times with soloists, ensembles and orchestras from the institutions where he studied. For the Orchestra of the "Niccolò Piccinni" Conservatory in Bari he wrote "Variazioni" for orchestra, performed in 2016, and "Daedalus" for orchestra and fixed electronics, performed in 2018. In May 2019 the world premiere of "Hex-A" for string sextet took place, entrusted to the soloists of the Accademia d'Archi Arrigoni.

Recent premieres include "Pinax" for solo violin at Teatro Studio Borgna in Rome in May 2021, "Corpora" for eleven instruments and "In the middle of" for two performers and electroacoustic devices in June 2022, "Cartigli" for piano and ensemble in Ferrara in November 2022, "Projections" for string trio and live electronics at ArteScienza 2023 in Rome, and "Preludio ai riti del fuoco", commissioned by the ICO Symphony Orchestra of the Metropolitan City of Bari, in March 2024.

Three further commissions are dedicated to the same concert institution: "Imago Hominis Myrae" (2025) for narrator, orchestra and fixed media - a work centred on the cult of Saint Nicholas and connected to the broader IHM project for the artificial reconstruction of memories of historical figures - premiered in September 2025 at

the Teatro Piccinni in Bari; "Del quieto smarrirsi" (2026) for orchestra, after Henry Purcell's "Chaconne in G minor" Z. 730, premiered for the opening of the Bari Metropolitan Orchestra's 2026 season under Neil Thomson; and "Gesto primo" (2026) for narrator, artificial narrating voices on fixed media and orchestra, written for the eightieth anniversary of the Italian Constitution and premiered in May 2026 at the Auditorium "Nino Rota" in Bari under Jean François Verdier.

"Innesto: Habitat della Memoria" (2025), for choir, percussion ensemble and orchestra, was written for the ICO Fondazione Orchestra Sinfonica di Sanremo and premiered in December 2025 at the Teatro Centrale in Sanremo.

Among his most frequently performed compositions is "(ec)stasis" for marimba, vibraphone, multi-percussion and live electronics, which in 2024 was performed in six concerts in South America, followed by a further performance for Notti Sacre 2025 at the Auditorium Diocesano Vallisa in Bari.

In July 2025 the ArteScienza Festival produced "IHM", a concert-opera for reciting voices on fixed media, artificial voices, four augmented cellos and live electronics, premiered at the Goethe-Institut Auditorium in Rome: a work of about fifty minutes that uses artificial intelligence to question the authenticity of emotions and memories.

Alongside his orchestral output, he maintains an intense activity of commissioned chamber and electroacoustic works. For S.I.M.C. he wrote "Lumina" (2024) for fixed media, performed at the SIMC Autumn Festival in Desenzano del Garda and programmed at the 2026 International Csound Conference in Trapani, and "La notte" (2025) for reciting voice and electric guitar, on the short story by Lucy Gazzieri, presented in Verona. For the "Ri-letture" series of the Traetta Opera Festival in Bitonto he composed "Canto senza pietra" (2025) for flute, alto saxophone and piano, entrusted to the Ozone Sea Trio, and "Corda, rito, sacrificio" (2026) for solo violin, after Tommaso Traetta's "Ifigenia in Tauride", published by SZ Sugar and premiered on 10 October 2026 at the Teatro Traetta in Bitonto by Elisso Gogibedaschwili. In 2026 these are joined by "Il filo e l'eco" for piano, performed by Francesco Lomuscio in Barbarano del Capo, "Automaton 25" for clarinet, cello and piano, scheduled for the Spazio Giovani series in Acquaviva delle Fonti, and "Temporalities Alpha" for multi-percussion and live electronics, scheduled with Aldo Chiarulli at the Conservatories of Livorno and Modena.

His works are published by SZ Sugar, Stradivarius, Taukay and Da Vinci Publishing.

Research and Publications

His research, carried out as part of his doctorate, focuses on artificial memory, the computational modelling of musical form, roughness as a parameter for analysing musical recurrences, and ontological models of musical time.

In 2024 he co-authored "In Human Memories. Tecnica, creatività e autodeterminazione: una proposta etica", published in the journal Ex Chordis (Milano University Press); "Opening mind by opening architecture: analysis strategies", presented at the 7th International Csound Conference at the University of Music and Performing Arts Vienna; and "Archeotopologie: implementazione critica di memorie senza colore", in the proceedings of the XXIV Colloquium on Music Informatics at the IUAV University of Venice.

In 2026 three of his papers, released as arXiv preprints, were accepted at international conferences, where they will be presented in October: "From local kernels to global form: modeling the emergence of musical content" and "Memory as transformation: LETHE, a self-referential GAN-inspired architecture" at the XXV Colloquium on Music Informatics in L'Aquila, and "One Timeline, Many Renderings: A Wolfram Language Paclet for heterogeneous musical output" at the 8th International Csound Conference in Trapani. In the same month he will speak at the Second National Conference of AFAM Doctoral Candidates (DISCo AFAM 2026) in Terni with "Temporal System: un modello ontologico del tempo musicale".

He presented his studies on roughness at the "Musica e/è scienza" conference at the "Niccolò Piccinni" Conservatory in Bari (2025) and at E.C.O. 2026 - Elettronica Condivisa Online, and has taken part in public talks on music and artificial intelligence, including "La musica. Da Pitagora all'AI" for the Concerti del Politecnico di Bari (2025).

Artistic Residencies

In November 2026 he will be in residence in Ruvo di Puglia to record "Ruh", an album for the TACTUS label, to be presented in concert in February 2027.

Among his recent artistic residencies, "Mousike et Arete" stands out: promoted by the Italian Ministry for Cultural Heritage and Activities in collaboration with Orchestra della Magna Grecia and ArCoPu, it led him to compose "Taras", a cantata for baritone, choir and orchestra dedicated to the city of Taranto.

He was also a guest in Saint-Étienne in May 2021 for the Journées Art & Science 2021, where he presented "At the origin of" for saxophone and Sampo, and in 2022 he took part in the "Creative Dialogue France" artistic residency programme at the Château de Beauchêne in Champtocé-sur-Loire, where he created "Sospira l'acqua".

Other Activities

In October 2020 the Puglia Region awarded him a professional qualification certificate as "Head of musical composition and writing", a recognition that enabled him to begin collaborations with the Paolo Grassi Foundation in Martina Franca.

Since November 2020 he has been responsible for the Music Analysis seminar for students of the Master of Arts in Orchestral Conducting at the Conservatory of Italian Switzerland. In April 2021, at the same institution, he collaborated with Nadir Vassena as assistant to the Algorithmic Composition course.

He has taught Music Technologies in several upper secondary schools. Between 2023 and 2024 he was a Composition teacher at the "G. Rossini" Conservatory in Pesaro.